

Figure 1: Pipelining options

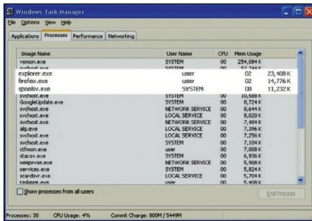


Figure 2: Firefox memory use – when minimised

Configure Firefox to use 10 MB RAM when minimised: Open the *about:config* box; right-click anywhere in the 'Preference name' pane, then create a new Boolean variable – *config.trim_on_minimize*, and set its value to 'True'.

This is especially useful for systems with low RAM, or if you see heavy RAM usage by Firefox under the task manager.

View source code in your preferred editor

Start by entering *about:config* in a new Firefox tab, search for *view_source.editor* and change the following options:

```
view_source.editor.external    true
view_source.editor.path       Enter your editor path
```

Now, pressing *Ctrl-U* will open the source code in the editor mentioned in the path. For example, you may enter *c:\windows\notepad.exe* for viewing (or editing) the code in Notepad. This could really be helpful for developers and testers.

Ensure privacy while browsing

Disable third party cookies, and delete all cookies when you close Firefox:

```
Tools - Options - Privacy
Use custom settings for history
Accept cookies from sites
Accept third party cookies - never
```



Figure 3: Firefox memory use – when maximised



Figure 4: Trackers blocked by Ghostery on a prominent media website

Keep until - I close Firefox
Select 'Tell sites that I do not want to be tracked' under Tools - Options - Privacy

Websites store information about you in cookies, which are accessed whenever you visit the same site again. This is primarily used for various reasons such as 'Keep me signed in', providing customised contents to you.

Third party cookies are those that are placed in your computer by sites that you are not visiting—you may wish to block them all together.

Use the add-on, Ghostery: Most of the websites you browse through, track and record your activity – even though you have selected 'Tell sites that I do not want to be tracked'. They could also be selling this information. Ghostery detects these trackers and allows you to block them. It's available for free at <https://addons.mozilla.org/en-US/firefox/addon/ghostery/>

Use the Adblock Plus add-on to block advertisements

On many websites, advertisements are one of the the biggest nuisances. Adblock Plus blocks banners, pop-ups and video advertisements. Install it to see the difference-it is unbelievable.

There are various user configurable settings for this add-on:

1. Subscribe to various filters to block advertisements.
2. Disable this add-on for particular websites
3. By default, this add-on allows some non-intrusive advertisements such as those by google to be displayed - user can disable them from filter preferences.
4. Create custom rule for blocking particular contents such as advertisement, banner or video if not automatically blocked.

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